

# Marco Laffranchi

Technology-Driven Business Development & Growth Leader

Winterthur, ZH, Switzerland

Swiss citizen

Languages: Italian (native); German, French, English and Spanish (fluent)

Inventor/co-inventor of 9 industrial technology patents

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## Profile

Executive-level business development and engineering leader who turns advanced technologies into commercially viable products and new-market opportunities. Combines customer insight, technical depth and production economics to give top management clear investment options.

Builds skilled multidisciplinary teams and leads commercialization from customer pain points and willingness to pay through specifications, business cases, industrialization, sales enablement and market deployment. Led direct CEO/CTO mandates across engineering, operations, sales, marketing and finance.

**Selected impact:** supported more than CHF 20M in investment decisions; developed a sensor portfolio that reached approximately 50% market share in its target segment within three years; inventor or co-inventor of nine industrial technology patents.

## Core Leadership & Business Development Competencies

- New-market development, growth strategy and technology-driven business development.
- Executive decision support: strategic options, business cases, ROI, risks and investment recommendations.
- Customer pain-point analysis, willingness-to-pay, value propositions and specification optimization.
- Product and portfolio strategy, technology roadmaps, pricing and revenue forecasting.
- Industrialization, design for manufacture, capital investment and cost-of-goods optimization.
- Multidisciplinary team building, capability development and cross-functional leadership.
- Sales enablement, strategic customer support, market deployment and feedback integration.
- Competitive intelligence, patent strategy, positioning and professional product marketing.

## Professional Experience

### Independent Consultant / Engineering Services, Winterthur (CH)

*Business Development and Technology Consultant*

**04/2026 – present**

- Develop business cases, technical concepts and commercialization strategies for technology-driven products and industrial systems.
- Defined the concept and industrialization strategy for an automated thin-film metal-deposition line targeting investment below CHF 100k and unit cost below CHF 5 at scale, with emphasis on competitive differentiation and scalable production.
- Developed a business case, system concept and patent proposals for a vibration-control solution addressing an emerging quantum-computing application.

### Kistler Instrumente AG, Winterthur (CH)

*Head of Technology-Driven Business Development*

**01/2020 – 03/2026**

- Built and led an eight-person business development and technology team and coordinated approximately 20 colleagues across engineering, operations, sales, marketing and finance.
- Identified and assessed new markets, applications and technology opportunities under a direct CEO/CTO mandate; presented management with clear strategic options, assumptions, risks and recommendations.
- Developed business cases supporting more than CHF 20M in product and market investment decisions, integrating market sizing, regional pricing, revenue forecasts, technical feasibility, investment needs and competitive positioning.
- Engaged strategic customers worldwide to identify unmet needs and willingness to pay, then translated the customer voice into differentiated value propositions and economically realistic specifications.
- Built product and technology roadmaps connecting customer demand, internal capabilities, product differentiation, industrialization requirements and go-to-market priorities.
- Established a model for transitioning selected products from manual assembly to automated production, supporting scalability, cost reduction and future growth.
- Led initiatives in sensor miniaturization, modularization and platform development; established differentiation through market, patent and technology analysis.
- Steered market deployment with global sales centres: developed country-level market and revenue plans, enabled sales engineers, supported strategic customer discussions and integrated field feedback into product decisions.
- Coordinated professional positioning and launch activities with marketing and managed strategic collaborations in semiconductor equipment, predictive maintenance and vibration-control applications.

### *Head of Sensor Development Engineering*

**01/2014 – 12/2019**

- Led six expert engineers and coordinated four contributors responsible for technology development, product platforms and industrialization.
- Managed technology and product portfolios, resource priorities and capability development under a direct CEO/CTO mandate.
- Built team structures, engineering practices and knowledge-transfer processes to support organizational growth and reduce dependency on individual experts.
- Directed platform development and product improvements across demanding industrial applications, balancing performance, manufacturability, reliability and cost.

### *Senior Engineering and Project Manager*

**05/2010 – 12/2013**

- Managed multidisciplinary product-development projects from opportunity definition through industrialization and market launch.
- Developed and launched a high-temperature gas-turbine sensor portfolio, including ATEX-certified amplification electronics with leading signal-to-noise performance and reliability.
- Developed and launched a shock-wave and high-speed characterization portfolio that reached approximately 50% share of its target segment within three years, with particularly strong growth in Asia.

### **Bieri Engineering GmbH, Winterthur (CH)**

#### *Lead Engineer for High-End Research and Industrial Systems*

**09/2008 – 04/2010**

- Led a small engineering team and supervised assembly activities for complex, high-value technical systems.
- Delivered custom systems for international research and industrial customers, managing technical definition, supplier interfaces, cost constraints and implementation.
- Engineered and assembled a CHF 5M cryogenic tank for a NASA space experiment and launch conditions.
- Designed and built detector and cryogenic systems for ETH Zurich, CERN and the University of Bern within demanding technical and budget constraints.
- Worked with EMPA and Sulzer Innotec on hydrogen-storage and energy-system development projects.

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## **International Research Experience**

### **ETH Zurich / CERN, Geneva (CH)**

#### *Postdoctoral Researcher and Lecturer*

**2005 – 2008**

- Coordinated scientific activities across an international collaboration of seven universities and served as CERN laboratory safety officer for 35 researchers.
- Lectured in particle physics at ETH Zurich.
- Authored or co-authored approximately 25 peer-reviewed publications in particle physics and detector technology, with more than 1,500 citations.

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## **Selected Industry & Technology Exposure**

- Industrial sensing and instrumentation, advanced manufacturing, automation and precision systems.
- Analog and digital electronics, high-voltage systems, optics, astronomical instrumentation and satellite applications.
- Scientific and engineering software development, programming, automation and data analysis.
- AI-enabled electronics and data-acquisition products, AI-driven business analysis and big-data applications.
- Semiconductor equipment, predictive maintenance, vibration control and emerging quantum technologies.
- Cryogenic, vacuum and scientific instrumentation for large international research programs.
- Gas turbines, high-temperature applications, high-dynamic measurements and harsh-environment electronics.
- Hydrogen storage, thermal systems and energy-related engineering studies.

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## **Education**

### **ETH Zurich, Zurich (CH)**

#### *Diploma and Doctorate in Experimental Particle Physics*

**1995 – 2004**

- Specialization in particle-accelerator and detector technology.